

\$111,000,000. *And counting.*

That's how much the tobacco industry has already given for independent research on smoking and health. That figure will grow by another \$7.7 million before the year is over.

And by "independent" we mean that scientists applying these funds autonomously in more than 350 medical and research institutions, have been encouraged to publish whatever they find, whatever the outcome.

\$111,000,000. More than the American Cancer Society, the American Heart Association and the American Lung Association combined.

And yet legislation pending right now at the State Capital would increase cigarette taxes over \$3 million a year to fund cancer research. Just last month the Legislature increased taxes on cigarettes more than \$25 million over a four-year period to pay for additional cells for Arizona's burgeoning prison population.

Is it fair to place even *more* tax burden on those who choose to smoke, in spite of the fact that cigarettes are already the single most heavily taxed consumer product? Is it fair to tax only one segment of the population to pay for a research center which will be available to all the people including non-smokers?

The estimated 740,000 smokers in Arizona last year paid over \$41 million in cigarette excise taxes, \$9 million in sales taxes, to state and local treasuries to fund services that benefit all of the state's 2.7 million population. They also paid an additional \$37.5 million in Federal taxes which now amount to 16 cents a pack.

Think about it. Consider where the tobacco industry stands.

It stands, as it has for thirty years, squarely behind its research commitment, and firmly behind its own responsibility to help find definitive answers to the questions about smoking and health.

The Tobacco Institute

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